TASK 4: SEVERITY & CASE CLASSIFICATION

Internship: Pharmacovigilance
Course: Bachelor of Pharmacy (B.Pharm)

1. Aim

To classify adverse drug reactions based on seriousness and expectedness and evaluate their potential clinical impact.

2. Introduction

Adverse drug reaction classification is an important part of pharmacovigilance. It helps healthcare professionals understand the clinical impact of medicine-related reactions and identify cases requiring urgent attention.

ADRs are classified according to seriousness and expectedness.

3. Classification of ADRs

A. Serious ADR

A serious adverse drug reaction results in one or more of the following:

- Death.
- Life-threatening condition.
- Hospitalisation or prolongation of hospitalisation.
- Persistent or significant disability.
- Congenital anomaly or birth defect.
- Other medically important conditions.

B. Non-Serious ADR

A non-serious ADR does not meet the regulatory criteria for seriousness.

C. Expected ADR

An expected ADR is consistent with the applicable approved product information.

D. Unexpected ADR

An unexpected ADR is not consistent with the applicable approved product information.

4. Case Analysis

Drug	Adverse Reaction	Seriousness	Expectedness
Amoxicillin	Skin rash and itching	Non-serious	Expected

Ibuprofen	GI bleeding requiring hospitalisation	Serious	Expected
Metformin	Lactic acidosis	Serious	Unexpected
Atorvastatin	Mildly elevated liver enzymes	Non-serious	Unexpected
Levofloxacin	Tendon rupture	Serious	Unexpected

5. Clinical Importance

1. Helps identify potentially dangerous adverse reactions.
2. Supports patient safety.
3. Helps healthcare professionals prioritise ADR reports.
4. Improves medicine safety monitoring.
5. Supports regulatory pharmacovigilance activities.

6. Summary

In the five examples, three reactions are classified as serious and two as non-serious. Expectedness is assessed separately from seriousness.

7. Conclusion

Severity and case classification are essential components of pharmacovigilance. Correct classification helps healthcare professionals evaluate the clinical impact of adverse drug reactions and improve patient safety.